



SPAIN

Capital city: Madrid

Area: 194,896 sq miles
(504,782 sq km)

Population: 41,100,000

Official language:
Spanish, Galician, Basque,
CatalanMajor religions: Christian
96%, other 4%Government: Multiparty
democracy

Currency: Euro

Adult literacy rate: 98%

Life expectancy: 78 years

People per doctor: 303

Televisions: 506 per
1,000 people

SPAIN

FIESTAS AND FLAMENCO provide much of the flavor of Spain. Most Spaniards are Roman Catholic and fiestas, often to celebrate a local saint's day, include processions of people in traditional clothing, music, and dancing. After a bitter civil war in 1936–39, Spain was ruled by a dictator, Francisco Franco, until 1975. His successor, King Juan Carlos I, has restored democracy. Today, Spain is a major industrial nation with a large agricultural sector and a booming tourist trade. These activities are mainly based near the coasts, while central regions are less developed.

Wooden castanets
played by dancers

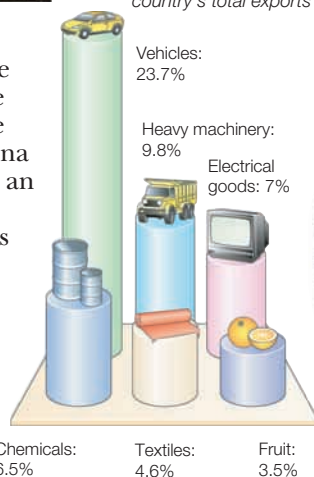
FLAMENCO

Flamenco is the name given to the music and dance style developed by the gypsies of Andalusia in the 15th century. Dancers in traditional outfits, men in black and women in frilled dresses, stamp their heels and click castanets while flamenco music is played on a guitar.

Fan held by
flamenco
dancerThe guitar originated in
Spain in the 16th century.
This model is a 19th-
century court guitar.

INDUSTRY

Farming and fishing used to be the basis of the Spanish economy. The country has now developed a large steel industry, centered in Barcelona in the north, and has also become an important center for making cars. In the 1980s, many new electronics and high-tech industries were set up, often supported by money from foreign investment. Major agricultural products include cereals, olives, grapes for wine, and citrus fruits, especially oranges from around Seville.



CITIES OF SPAIN

Madrid, shown here, became Spain's capital in 1561 because King Philip II liked its climate and central location. Today, the city has a population of some 4 million people and is Spain's center of finance and government. Barcelona is Spain's second city and the capital of Catalonia. It lies at the heart of a large industrial area in the north and was the site of the 1992 Olympic Games.



PEOPLE OF SPAIN

The Spanish are divided into regional groups, some with their own language and culture. Local languages, include Catalan, Galician, and Euskera from the Basque region, which stretches from northern Spain into France. The official language of Spain, Castilian, is taught in all schools, along with either English or French. Children in Spain tend to stay up late. They have a snack called *merienda* after school, then play outside, with a late family dinner held around 9 pm.

SPANISH RESORTS

About 50 million tourists flock to Spain every year to enjoy the beaches and admire the architecture of cities such as Barcelona and Seville. Beaches on the Costa del Sol, as well as on the Balearic Island of Majorca, shown here, are popular with tourists from Britain and Germany. Bullfighting, held in arenas in most cities, either attracts or repels tourists.



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